THE LANGUAGE BARRIER

The key challenge when it comes to skilling Indian workers for jobs in Japan

India and Japan have a very strong relationship, with almost 1,500 Japanese companies and their branches working in India, says **Atul Kumar Tiwari**, Secretary, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship. Japan is also the fifth-largest investor in India. But there are challenges too in terms of skilling Indian workers for jobs in Japan.

A NEW APPROACH

Over so many years, there has been a change in the way that Japan is looking at skilled people coming from India. Since 2017, when India and Japan decided to expand the bilateral cooperation in the skill development sector, around 1,200 people from India have been sent to Japan to undergo internship under the Technical Intern Training Program (TITP).

The Japanese side have also started schemes under which the Japanese can come to India for a specified period to help in teaching the Japanese language as language is a big barrier. We have around 20 training centres, and, in fact, our National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC) International has set up a Japanese school in Gurugram, Haryana. But there are very few Japanese language teachers in India. If we have to scale up the number of people going to Japan, we need to look into how to augment the supply of Japanese teachers.

Also, we need to have a greater connect not only with the Indian companies in Japan but also the Japanese company in Japan. And that is where we have already set up a person in Tokyo. We have an NSDC international office there. ■

THE SKILLING CHALLENGE
LONG-TERM SOLUTIONS

Atul Kumar Tiwari, *Secretary, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship*



Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**



MUSICAL EXCHANGE
INDIA MEETS JAPAN

“THE SPIRITUAL CONTENT OF JAPANESE CLASSICAL MUSIC IS VERY SIMILAR TO INDIAN MUSIC. AND I THINK THAT’S WHAT CONNECTS US. MUSIC IS BEYOND LANGUAGE AND CREED. SO WHEN I MET AND COLLABORATED WITH JAPANESE MUSICIANS, MORE THAN UNDERSTANDING WHAT THE OTHER SAID, WE WERE EXCHANGING OUR THOUGHTS THROUGH MUSIC. MUSIC DOES NOT NEED WORDS.... WE CAN CONVERSE THROUGH THE ETERNAL SEVEN NOTES OF MUSIC.... FOR US MUSIC DOESN’T NEED ALPHABETS”

PANDIT SHUBHENDRA RAO
Sitar maestro and composer